

Word Prompts

for Salvation and Discipleship

By Jason Hayward

May the Lamb that was slain receive the reward of His suffering

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Introduction

There are some good tools out there that can help you to present the gospel of Jesus Christ, in obedience to the command of Jesus to His disciples: “Go therefore and make disciples...” (Matthew 28:19a ESV). Disciples, then and now, are those who put Christ’s words into practice in their daily lives. Those good tools include the [Four Spiritual Laws](#), [the Bridge to Life](#), and the Romans Road to Salvation (for example, see [here](#)). Out of those, the first is my favorite, given its presentation and completeness.

In this book, I present a new method based on word prompts for salvation and discipleship. It is meant as a simple way to present the gospel message, while also introducing the would-be-disciple to the covenant they must make with our Lord. While salvation through Christ is a free gift of God, it does require one to make a lifelong commitment to fully orient themselves to God *that completely transforms their life and purpose*. After all, new life in Christ isn’t something one gets to *add into* their current life; instead, it’s a *complete overhaul of life* that requires one to disavow themselves of and discard their life-to-date. As such, this method is to be used to present salvation to the would-be-disciple in a first conversation, and to more naturally introduce the additional conversions about discipleship that should always follow one’s decision to become a follower of Jesus Christ.

The command of God to us is not to make more Christians; the world doesn’t need more Christians, if they do not put Christ’s words into practice. Instead, we are to make more disciples.

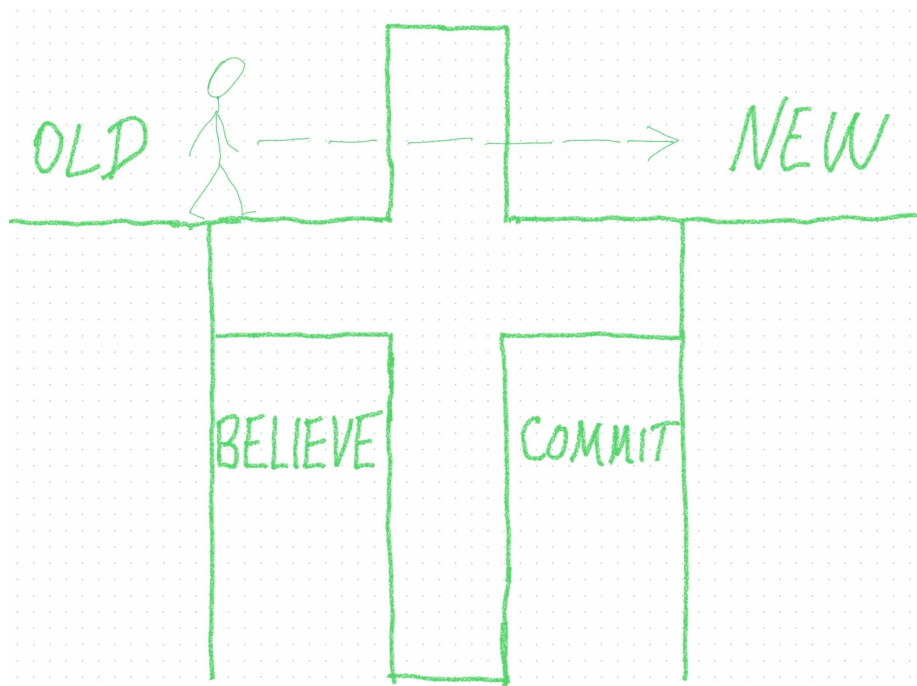
Our world desperately needs more disciples.

So let’s get up, get out there, and be bold today. And, for those that have ears to hear (Matthew 11:15), let’s finish what we start with them.

Old

The word prompts for salvation and discipleship appear in English below. For word prompts in Spanish, or Portuguese, see [Appendix: Words prompts translations](#).

Old:	Doubt	Sin	Separation	Unrighteousness	Slavery	Death
New:	Trust	Sinless	Directly connected	Righteousness	Freedom	Life
Believe:	God is good	Jesus Christ	Holy Spirit	Full identification	Set free	Quickened
Commit:	Know God	Repentance	Fellowship	Lordship of Christ	Love	Baptism



The two graphics above should be copied onto the cell phone or tablet you carry around with you. Below are some notes for you to remember.

Old

Doubt God's goodness, look out for yourself and your interests

Sin: self-oriented; self-will; active rebellion, passive indifference

Separation from God; judgment, condemnation, hell

Unrighteousness (position, lifestyle)

Slavery

Death (wages of sin; spiritual, physical)

Salvation discussion

The Bible explains that God is good. He created us good, He's the source of all things good, and His intent is for our good.

Yet, we all naturally **doubt** God, causing us to think we need to look out for ourselves and our own interests. By nature, we lead self-directed, self-centered lives.

This nature is a fallen nature. It's a nature characterized by some combination of active rebellion and passive indifference toward the God who created us. Out of this nature, we **sin** as a lifestyle.

God created a legal system, and we are all law breakers in this system. Our sin causes **separation** from God and from relationship with Him, like a chasm we can never cross. We sense this separation; we sense something is not right in our lives. We experience a need for something or someone to fill some gap within us and make things right. Our state in relation to God can best be described as one of **unrighteousness**.

Disconnected from God and from right thinking, and trying to meet our own needs in the ways we think best, we are subject to the **slavery** of sin. We are prisoners to it, unable to break free in our own power. Yet, the things that we try to use to satisfy us are all as a vapor, quickly vanishing just after we reach for them.

Instead of satisfying us or making things right in our lives, the result of sin is condemnation and **death**. Since our nature is sinful, we are spiritually dead. Sin also naturally leads to physical death and, ultimately, to hell, which is eternal separation from God and His goodness.

Discussion time: About a minute and a half

Discipleship discussion

Doubt

It's natural for us to doubt God's goodness, believing either that He is holding back good from us or that He isn't inclined to meet our needs and wants. This is the thought introduced to the mind of man at the beginning of creation:

"Now the serpent was more crafty than any other beast of the field that the Lord God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God actually say, 'You shall not eat of any tree in the garden'?'"

Genesis 3:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gen.3.1.ESV>

God actually is inclined to meet our needs and wants, as Jesus taught:

“Now Jesus was praying in a certain place, and when he finished, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, as John taught his disciples.” And he said to them, “When you pray, say: “Father, hallowed be your name. Your kingdom come. Give us each day our daily bread, and forgive us our sins, for we ourselves forgive everyone who is indebted to us. And lead us not into temptation.” And he said to them, “Which of you who has a friend will go to him at midnight and say to him, ‘Friend, lend me three loaves, for a friend of mine has arrived on a journey, and I have nothing to set before him’; and he will answer from within, ‘Do not bother me; the door is now shut, and my children are with me in bed. I cannot get up and give you anything’? I tell you, though he will not get up and give him anything because he is his friend, yet because of his impudence he will rise and give him whatever he needs. And I tell you, ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and it will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives, and the one who seeks finds, and to the one who knocks it will be opened. What father among you, if his son asks for a fish, will instead of a fish give him a serpent; or if he asks for an egg, will give him a scorpion? If you then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him!””

Luke 11:1-13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.11.1-13.ESV>

Yet, in our wrong thinking, we tend not to believe it. As Paul said about the Phillippian church, “... they all seek their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ.”

Philippians 2:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.2.21.ESV>

Sin

This is sin. Sin stems from self-interest and self-will. The Apostle Paul defined sin in the following way:

“...For whatever does not proceed from faith is sin.”

Romans 14:23b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.14.23.ESV>

Sin includes not only the wrong that we choose to do (or commit), but the right we choose not to do (or omit):

“So whoever knows the right thing to do and fails to do it, for him it is sin.”

James 4:17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.4.17.ESV>

Separation

“for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God,”

Romans 3:23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.3.23.ESV>

The glory of God refers to the splendor, majesty, and excellence of God’s nature, bright shining as the sun. As such, the standard of God’s law is high; it’s impossible for us to meet it on our own in our fallen condition.

As a result, there is separation between God and mankind, just as there was separation from God and man when Adam and Eve were cast out of Eden (Genesis 3:24). This has resulted in spiritual blindness as well:

“...the god of this world has blinded the minds of the unbelievers, to keep them from seeing the light of the gospel of the glory of Christ, who is the image of God.”

2 Corinthians 4:4b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.4.4.ESV>

The “god of this world” is Satan. The separation of mankind from God in life leads to the same in death, as Jesus described in his parable of the rich man and Lazarus, where the former was in hell and the latter in heaven:

“And besides all this, between us and you a great chasm has been fixed, in order that those who would pass from here to you may not be able, and none may cross from there to us.”

Luke 16:26 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.16.26.ESV>

For those who do not know God and are disobedient to the gospel of Jesus Christ, the Bible describes hell this way:

“They will suffer the punishment of eternal destruction, away from the presence of the Lord and from the glory of his might,”

2 Thessalonians 1:9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2th.1.9.ESV>

God’s righteous nature and the disobedience of His creation requires judgment, for the one thing our perfect God cannot do is go against His own word. After all, God is not good and loving if He is not just. All is to be made right in the end. If it’s not right yet, it’s not the end.

Jesus Christ made God’s standard for judgment clear:

“The one who rejects me and does not receive my words has a judge; the word that I have spoken will judge him on the last day. For I have not spoken on my own authority, but the Father who sent me has himself given me a commandment—what to say and what to speak.”

John 12:48-49 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.12.48-49.ESV>

We will be judged by the words Jesus spoke when He came, as recorded in the Bible.

Unrighteousness

The Bible describes our position and our lifestyle of unrighteousness the following way:

“And you were dead in the trespasses and sins in which you once walked, following the course of this world, following the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that is now at work in the sons of disobedience— among whom we all once lived in the passions of our flesh, carrying out the desires of the body and the mind, and were by nature children of wrath, like the rest of mankind.”

Ephesians 2:1-3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.1-3.ESV>

The prince of the power of the air is Satan. His spirit is now at work in those who disobey God’s laws, carrying out their own passions and desires.

Slavery

Regarding slavery to sin,

“Jesus answered them, “Truly, truly, I say to you, everyone who practices sin is a slave to sin... You are doing the works your father did.” ...You are of your father the devil, and your will is to do your father’s desires...”

John 8:34, 41a, 44a ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.8.34-44.ESV>

Disconnected from God and from right thinking, and trying to meet our own needs in the ways we think best, we are subject to the **slavery** of sin. We are prisoners to it, unable to break free in our own power.

Yet, the things that we try to use to satisfy us are all as a vapor, quickly vanishing. It’s as King Solomon said:

“I have seen everything that is done under the sun, and behold, all is vanity and a striving after wind.”

Ecclesiastes 1:14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/ecc.1.14.ESV>

Death

“For the wages of sin is death...”

Romans 6:23a ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.6.23.ESV>

Sin results not only in slavery, but in death, both spiritual and physical. Since the spirit inside of us is dead, we have no relationship with God and no communication from God. God to us is as the Father waiting for the prodigal son to return to Him (Luke 15:11-13).

We will also all die physically:

“And just as it is appointed for man to die once, and after that comes judgment,”

Hebrews 9:27 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/heb.9.27.ESV>

There is nothing we can do to remedy our situation:

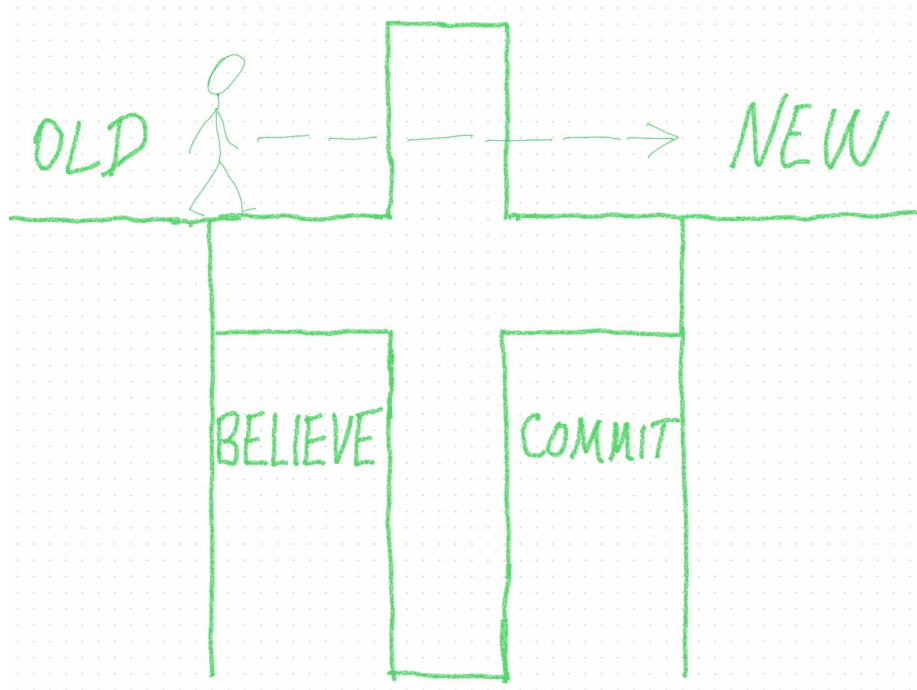
“We have all become like one who is unclean, and all our righteous deeds are like a polluted garment...”

Isaiah 64:6a ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/isa.64.6.ESV>

New

Old:	Doubt	Sin	Separation	Unrighteousness	Slavery	Death
New:	Trust	Sinless	Directly connected	Righteousness	Freedom	Life
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Below are some notes for you to remember.

New

Trust God's goodness and good will

Sinless as Jesus is

Directly connected to God as Jesus is

Righteousness (position, lifestyle)

Freedom, healing

Life spirit made alive

Salvation discussion

Jesus Christ offers the gift of salvation to you. It will completely transform your thinking and your life, making you a new creation.

In new life, your doubt will be replaced by faith, or **trust** in God's goodness and His good will to all.

In this new life, you are made as **sinless**, just as Jesus Christ is sinless. As far as the east is from the west, God removes your sin from you. Further, you become **directly connected** to God, as Jesus is connected to God.

In this new life, your new position is one of **righteousness** before God. You are in right relationship with Him as a child of God, and you are empowered to live a right lifestyle of victory over sin. Your will and your life purpose are made right.

This new life that Christ offers is one of **freedom**. Christ's finished work of suffering and death for you sets you free from sin and death. Nothing will have the power to hold you captive or oppress you in this life, sin and sickness included.

Jesus Christ died for you to bring you fully to **life**. God, by His nature, is life and life abundant. Your reconnection to Him makes your dead spirit alive. Your continued connection to Him will infuse you with life, as a branch connected to a vine. You will be filled with such fullness of life that it will overflow from you.

Discussion time: About a minute and a half

Discipleship discussion

Trust

God is good, and His intent toward us is good. God is worthy of our complete trust. In fact, trust is God's main love language, so to speak.

As discussed in the last chapter, God actually is inclined to meet our needs and wants. The Bible tells us:

"And my God will supply every need of yours according to his riches in glory in Christ Jesus."

Philippians 4:19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.4.19.ESV>

We can trust God in this. We can and should expect Him to meet our needs. Further, our trust in God is a condition of Him meeting our wants:

"Therefore I tell you, whatever you ask in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours."

Mark 11:24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.11.24.ESV>

As Jesus instructed His disciples, our requests to Him should be aligned with those things that will bring glory to God:

“Whatever you ask in my name, this I will do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.”

John 14:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.14.13.ESV>

We can trust God because His will toward all is good, “... not wishing that any should perish, but that all should reach repentance.”

2 Peter 3:9b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2pe.3.9.ESV>

The Father’s willingness to do good was well described and demonstrated in Jesus’ ministry to a leper:

“And behold, a leper came to him and knelt before him, saying, “Lord, if you will, you can make me clean.” And Jesus stretched out his hand and touched him, saying, “I will; be clean.” And immediately his leprosy was cleansed.”

Matthew 8:2-3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.8.2-3.ESV>

God is always willing to do good. In fact, this is the very reason Jesus was sent to us:

“... God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power. He went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him.”

Acts 10:38 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.10.38.ESV>

The whole Bible is about trust in God, or, said another way, faith. In it, we see character studies of those who had faith and those who did not. In it, we see the recorded results of actions motivated out of faith in God, or of the lack of it.

Faith is the essential principle of the kingdom of God. It is the gateway not only to salvation, but also answered prayer – and to all blessing and all riches from God in Christ.

Faith activates God’s Spirit within us. It is the Spirit’s catalyst. We can stir up the Spirit by our trust in His character and His word.

We need to trust Him enough to speak. We need to trust Him and His word enough to act.

Faith is like a muscle. If we don't exercise it, we won't grow stronger. We won't mature. In fact, if we don't exercise it, we will backslide; our muscles will atrophy.

Faith is the courage to step out when everybody else wants to run the other way.

We are also to trust him to protect us, claiming the promise of His word, such as: "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the Lord, "My refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.""

Psalms 91:1-2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.91.1-2.ESV>

Speaking also of protection, Jesus said to His disciples, "Behold, I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy, and nothing shall hurt you."

Luke 10:19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.10.19.ESV>

In the end, we must all stand on our trust in God:

"Now faith is the assurance of things hoped for, the conviction of things not seen... And without faith it is impossible to please him, for whoever would draw near to God must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who seek him."

Hebrews 11:1, 6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/heb.11.1-6.ESV>

Sinless

You should trust God's word when it says that you have been made sinless as Jesus is "by canceling the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands. This he set aside, nailing it to the cross. He disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame, by triumphing over them in him."

Colossians 2:14-15 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.2.14-15.ESV>

Satan, who looks to accuse us (Revelation 12:10), can hold nothing against us, for "as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us."

Psalms 103:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.103.12.ESV>

Here is the opportunity that Christ's salvation affords us, if we enter into it:

"...though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they are red like crimson, they shall become like wool."

Isaiah 1:18b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/isa.1.18.ESV>

So our mindset as a new believer in Christ should be the following:

"...But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus."

Philippians 3:13b-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.3.13-14.ESV>

Directly connected

Entering into salvation through Christ our Lord, we join ourselves to Him:

"But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him."

1 Corinthians 6:17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.6.17.ESV>

We become one spirit with God. This connection is also described as being seated with Him in heavenly places:

"and raised us up with him and seated us with him in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus,"

Ephesians 2:6b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.6.ESV>

That's where Jesus Christ is now, and since we are one with Him in spirit, that's also where we are now, hidden in Him:

"For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God."

Colossians 3:3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.3.3.ESV>

Since we are of the same spirit, then as He is now in heaven, so are we in this world, as scripture teaches:

"... because as he is so also are we in this world."

1 John 4:17b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.4.17.ESV>

This connection makes us unified with the Father and with other disciples, just as Jesus Christ prayed that we would be:

“I do not ask for these only, but also for those who will believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, just as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be in us, so that the world may believe that you have sent me. The glory that you have given me I have given to them, that they may be one even as we are one, I in them and you in me, that they may become perfectly one, so that the world may know that you sent me and loved them even as you loved me.”

John 17:20-23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.17.20-23.ESV>

Besides our direct connection in spirit when we are made new creations, we have also received Christ's mind:

“For who knows a person's thoughts except the spirit of that person, which is in him? So also no one comprehends the thoughts of God except the Spirit of God. Now we have received not the spirit of the world, but the Spirit who is from God, that we might understand the things freely given us by God. And we impart this in words not taught by human wisdom but taught by the Spirit, interpreting spiritual truths to those who are spiritual. The natural person does not accept the things of the Spirit of God, for they are folly to him, and he is not able to understand them because they are spiritually discerned. The spiritual person judges all things, but is himself to be judged by no one. “For who has understood the mind of the Lord so as to instruct him?” But we have the mind of Christ.”

1 Corinthians 2:11-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.2.11-16.ESV>

The Greek word translated as instruct in the last verse also means “to join together” or “to cause a person to come to the same opinion.” This mind of Christ is the mind of the Spirit of God.

We are one spirit, we have His mind, and “... we are members of his body.”

Ephesians 5:30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.5.30.ESV>

That is being joined together with Christ in all three parts of our being: spirit, soul and body. The soul includes the mind, will and emotions. Our will is our own to give to God, just as Jesus had to do, when He said “... not my will, but yours, be done.”

Luke 22:42b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.22.42.ESV>

In giving our mind and will over to God, we, like Jesus, also come to experience the emotions of God. When the reason for Jesus' actions was given in the gospels, it was

said that "...he was moved with compassion on them, because they fainted, and were scattered abroad, as sheep having no shepherd."

Matthew 9:36b KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.9.36.KJV>

Righteousness

God wants you to know Him as the Lord my Righteousness (Jehovah Tsidkenu, Jeremiah 23:6). Those who are saved by Christ's work become righteous:

"For our sake he made him to be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God."

2 Corinthians 5:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.5.21.ESV>

Our position before God is right again, as if we had no sin. This is to have right standing with Him as a citizen in His kingdom. Not only this, but we are empowered to lead righteous lives, victorious over sin and evil, as Christ is. Righteousness is not only a position before God that allows Him to channel every good thing into us and through us, it is also a lifestyle:

"For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation for all people, training us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live self-controlled, upright, and godly lives in the present age, waiting for our blessed hope, the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ, who gave himself for us to redeem us from all lawlessness and to purify for himself a people for his own possession who are zealous for good works."

Titus 2:11-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/tit.2.11-14.ESV>

Those Christ makes righteous stop sinning:

"Whoever makes a practice of sinning is of the devil, for the devil has been sinning from the beginning. The reason the Son of God appeared was to destroy the works of the devil. No one born of God makes a practice of sinning, for God's seed abides in him; and he cannot keep on sinning, because he has been born of God. By this it is evident who are the children of God, and who are the children of the devil: whoever does not practice righteousness is not of God, nor is the one who does not love his brother."

1 John 3:8-10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.3.8-10.ESV>

God also makes our will right, aligning it with His. God's will is for us to do "good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them."

Ephesians 2:10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.10.ESV>

Our will is to become the same as that of Jesus when He taught us to pray,
“Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.”

Matthew 6:10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.6.10.ESV>

Those Christ makes righteous press on toward the upward call of God in Christ
Jesus—to walk in the same way in which He walked:

“whoever says he abides in him ought to walk in the same way in which he walked.”

1 John 2:6 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.2.6.ESV>

Freedom

Under God’s legal system, the only way to freedom now is through Jesus Christ and the gospel of the kingdom:

“There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus. For the law of the Spirit of life has set you free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death.”

Romans 8:1-2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.1-2.ESV>

The law of sin and death includes sin and everything associated with it. If you’re in Christ, you’re legally free from all of it.

That doesn’t mean we will not voluntarily or unknowingly submit to slavery though:

“For freedom Christ has set us free; stand firm therefore, and do not submit again to a yoke of slavery.”

Galatians 5:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.5.1.ESV>

But we should not, and we will not if we stand firm against any slavery and oppression. We need to be properly equipped to stand firm.

Jesus has enabled you to live as a child of God who is free:

“Jesus answered them, “Truly, truly, I say to you, everyone who practices sin is a slave to sin. The slave does not remain in the house forever; the son remains forever. So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.”

John 8:34-36 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.8.34-36.ESV>

So live as one set free.

Life

If you become a disciple of Christ, you have been quickened (made alive) together with Christ:

“But God, being rich in mercy, because of the great love with which he loved us, even when we were dead in our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ—by grace you have been saved—”

Ephesians 2:4-5 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.4-5.ESV>

Your spirit is alive. You are connected to God.

Your name is written in the book of life (Revelation 3:5). You are a child of God, with every blessing, with a rich inheritance and with the accompanying responsibility.

The Spirit of life (Romans 8:2) lives in you, if you are in Christ, and the law of the Spirit has set you free from death. Nothing can hold you captive.

That life in you will grow you up, if you let it, to be made just like Jesus in character and nature. This is why Jesus came: “...I came that they may have life and have it abundantly.”

John 10:10b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.10.10.ESV>

Christ also said:

“Whoever believes in me, as the Scripture has said, ‘Out of his heart will flow rivers of living water.’”

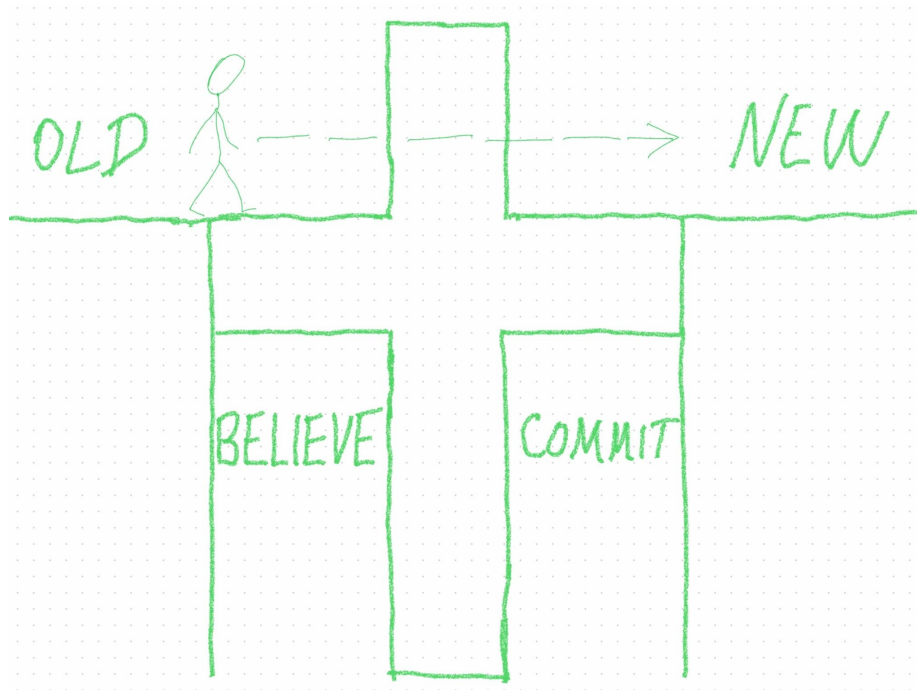
John 7:38 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.7.38.ESV>

God will pour His life into you, if you let Him, until channels of it flow out of you to others.

Believe

Old:	Doubt	Sin	Separation	Unrighteousness	Slavery	Death
New:	Trust	Sinless	Directly connected	Righteousness	Freedom	Life
Believe:	God is good	Jesus Christ	Holy Spirit	Full identification	Set free	Quickened
Commit:	Know God	Repentance	Fellowship	Lordship of Christ	Love	Baptism



Below are some notes for you to remember.

Believe and confess

God is good, wants good for you, loves you, is merciful

Jesus Christ is God's only provision for your sin; receive the gift of salvation

Receive the **Holy Spirit**, God's power; "Christ in you"; directly connected to God as Jesus is

Full identification with Jesus Christ: crucifixion, resurrection; you are now a child of God with inheritance and responsibility

Set free from sin, death, and their effects; made clean

Quickened (made alive) by God's life

Salvation discussion

If you want to be made new through salvation, you should do the following, after you have also considered the lifetime commitment to God you must make at the same time, which is covered in the next chapter titled [Commit](#).

Believe and confess that **God is good**. God wants good for you. He loves you. He is merciful to you. To confess means to say it aloud, believing it.

Believe and confess that **Jesus Christ** is God's only provision for your sin, and that you receive God's gift of salvation.

Believe and confess that you now have **full identification** with Jesus Christ in all things, including in His crucifixion and resurrection. You are now a child of God with the associated inheritance and responsibility that it brings.

Believe and confess that you receive the **Holy Spirit** along with power. Christ lives in you right now, and you are directly connected to God as Jesus is.

Believe and confess that you have been **set free** by the finished work of Jesus Christ from sin and death, their effects, and any oppression; they have no right to you in Jesus' name. You have been made clean.

Believe and confess that you are now **quicken**ed (made alive) by God's life. You are filled with His life.

Discussion time: About a minute and a half

Discipleship discussion

God is good

God wants you to know Him as your Creator, the one who made you good and gave you everything good, just as He was first known to Adam and Eve.

This is how God described Himself to Moses, and this is how He wants to be known by you:

"The Lord passed before him and proclaimed, "The Lord, the Lord, a God merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love and faithfulness, keeping

steadfast love for thousands, forgiving iniquity and transgression and sin, but who will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children and the children's children, to the third and the fourth generation.””

Exodus 34:6-7 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/exo.34.6-7.ESV>

The word used to describe God as good here and many times elsewhere in the Old Testament is *chêsêd* (pronounced kheh'-sed) which can be translated as goodness, mercy, kindness, lovingkindness, or faithfulness. His goodness also requires Him to not clear the guilty, as described in my book [God is good](#).

God wants you to come to know His goodness as you trust in Him. He wants to be known to you as the Lord my provider (Jehovah Jireh, Genesis 22:13-14), the Lord my healer (Jehovah Rapha, Exodus 15:26), the Lord my peace (Jehovah Shalom, Judges 6:24), the Lord who sees me (Jehovah El Roi, Genesis 16:13), the Lord my shepherd (Jehovah Rohi, Psalm 23:1).

God desires for you to know Him as Jesus does. Jesus said about His Father, “... No one is good except God alone.”

Mark 10:18b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.10.18.ESV>

God's goodness extended so far as to give His only Son for the love of you:

““For God so loved the world, that he gave his only Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish but have eternal life. For God did not send his Son into the world to condemn the world, but in order that the world might be saved through him.”

John 3:16-17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.3.16-17.ESV>

God did this in order to give you life now and “so that in the coming ages he might show the immeasurable riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.”

Ephesians 2:7 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.7.ESV>

Believe it and confess it. He is good.

Jesus Christ

As God's only solution to our sin and separation from Him, Jesus Christ died in our place:

“but God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us.”

Romans 5:8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.5.8.ESV>

Jesus did this to bring us to God:

“For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh but made alive in the spirit,”

1 Peter 3:18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.3.18.ESV>

You should believe and confess what scripture records about Him:

“...that Christ died for our sins in accordance with the Scriptures, that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day in accordance with the Scriptures, and that he appeared to Cephas [Peter], then to the twelve. Then he appeared to more than five hundred brothers at one time...”

1 Corinthians 15:3b-6a ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.15.3-6.ESV>

Jesus Christ said about Himself, “I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.”

John 14:6b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.14.6.ESV>

The Apostle Peter said about Him,

“And there is salvation in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved.”

Acts 4:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.4.12.ESV>

You must individually receive Jesus as your Savior and Lord in order to experience God’s love and plan for your life:

“But to all who did receive him, who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God,”

John 1:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.1.12.ESV>

Your belief, confession, and the life commitment you make in faith to follow Jesus Christ as Lord makes you a child of God. This is a gift of God’s grace:

“For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God, not a result of works, so that no one may boast.”

Ephesians 2:8-9 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.8-9.ESV>

Intending to be obedient to Christ's commands to you, you should also ask God to fill you with the power of the Holy Spirit, His gift to you as a child of God, just as the Apostle Peter described:

"And Peter said to them, "Repent and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. For the promise is for you and for your children and for all who are far off, everyone whom the Lord our God calls to himself.""

Acts 2:38-39 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.2.38-39.ESV>

Jesus said to His disciples:

"But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you, and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth."

Acts 1:8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.1.8.ESV>

God is calling you to Himself. Once you have entered into relationship with God through Jesus Christ, you should believe and confess that you have the Holy Spirit living in you, along with the Spirit's power.

You should believe and confess what the Apostle Paul taught about the Spirit:

"And it is God who establishes us with you in Christ, and has anointed us, and who has also put his seal on us and given us his Spirit in our hearts as a guarantee."

2 Corinthians 1:21-22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.1.21-22.ESV>

You need the gift of Spirit in you in order to be established in Christ. As such, God has anointed you, or consecrated you, as a child of His, considering the associated responsibility. This gift marks you and secures you as His own. The gift of the Spirit living in you is a guarantee of the fullness of your inheritance in Christ.

The Apostle Paul referred to this Spirit that lived in Him and lives in you as "Christ in you" (Colossians 1:27), or "the Spirit Jesus Christ" (Phillipians).

Jesus taught His disciples that the Spirit would be in them as a Helper (John 14:16, 26). About the Helper living in us, we should know what the Apostle John taught, "Little children, you are from God and have overcome them, for he who is in you is greater than he who is in the world."

1 John 4:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.4.4.ESV>

He who is in the world is the devil. It is by way of the anointing of the Holy Spirit that Jesus destroys the works of the devil (1 John 3:8), bringing near the kingdom of God to you. Once you have entered into life in Christ, the Holy Spirit lives in you continually. The Spirit of the presence of "...God... works in you, both to will and to work for his good pleasure."

Philippians 2:13b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.2.13.ESV>

We are to honor the Spirit every day by way of what we choose to say and do, saying and doing that which brings God pleasure and glory. In doing this, we are obedient to the direction that the Apostle Paul gave to his disciple, Timothy:

"Wherefore I put thee in remembrance that thou stir up the gift of God, which is in thee by the putting on of my hands. For God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind."

2 Timothy 1:6-7 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2ti.1.6-7.KJV>

We need to stir up the gift of God that is in us, if we are to become and to do what God has purposed for us. Knowing that the Holy Spirit lives in us, we are not to choose to say or do things that quench or extinguish His fire within us:

"Do not quench the Spirit."

1 Thessalonians 5:19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1th.5.19.ESV>

Full identification

Our choice to receive salvation through Jesus Christ represents a full identification with Him, including identification in His death, resurrection, and exaltation. It makes us now as He is.

Believe and confess your full identification with Jesus Christ.

The full identification includes identification with Him in death and resurrection, where death implies death to our old life of sin. The Apostle Paul said of this, "What shall we say then? Are we to continue in sin that grace may abound? By no means! How can we who died to sin still live in it? Do you not know that all of us who have been baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death? We were buried therefore with him by baptism into death, in order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory of

the Father, we too might walk in newness of life. For if we have been united with him in a death like his, we shall certainly be united with him in a resurrection like his. We know that our old self was crucified with him in order that the body of sin might be brought to nothing, so that we would no longer be enslaved to sin. For one who has died has been set free from sin. Now if we have died with Christ, we believe that we will also live with him. We know that Christ, being raised from the dead, will never die again; death no longer has dominion over him. For the death he died he died to sin, once for all, but the life he lives he lives to God. So you also must consider yourselves dead to sin and alive to God in Christ Jesus. Let not sin therefore reign in your mortal body, to make you obey its passions. Do not present your members to sin as instruments for unrighteousness, but present yourselves to God as those who have been brought from death to life, and your members to God as instruments for righteousness.”

Romans 6:1-13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.6.1-13.ESV>

Further, Paul said of Himself, as an example:

“I have been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me. And the life I now live in the flesh I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me.”

Galatians 2:20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.2.20.ESV>

Confess that you no longer live, but it is now Christ who lives in you. The Apostle Paul also taught that Christ’s exaltation to the right hand of God was included in our full identification with Him in our salvation:

“But God, being rich in mercy, because of the great love with which he loved us, even when we were dead in our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ—by grace you have been saved— and raised us up with him and seated us with him in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, so that in the coming ages he might show the immeasurable riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.”

Ephesians 2:4-7 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.4-7.ESV>

Confess that you are now seated with Jesus Christ in heavenly places. The section [Directly Connected](#) also describes your full identification with Jesus Christ.

Set free

The purpose of Christ’s ministry, as He described it, was to set us free:

“The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim liberty to the captives and recovering of sight to

the blind, to set at liberty those who are oppressed, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor."

Luke 4:18-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.4.18-19.ESV>

Jesus was anointed with the Holy Spirit to proclaim freedom of the captives and to set people free. This ministry will continue until He comes again; we continue to live in the year of the Lord's favor.

Believe and confess that you have been set free from sin and death in Christ. Confess it after this verse:

"There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus. For the law of the Spirit of life has set you free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death."

Romans 8:1-2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.1-2.ESV>

In Christ, you have now been set free from everything associated with the fall of man, as the Apostle Peter described:

"He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we might die to sin and live to righteousness. By his wounds you have been healed."

1 Peter 2:24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1pe.2.24.ESV>

Believe and confess this truth recorded by Peter, and also this one:

"So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed."

John 8:36 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.8.36.ESV>

You are free indeed! You are not set free to do as you please, but rather to choose to please and obey God, believing that only this leads to good for you and for others. Believe and confess that God's way is the only one that truly leads to freedom for you and for others.

Further, as a disciple of Christ, you have been commanded by God to continue Jesus' ministry to proclaim freedom and to bring freedom to others:

"And as ye go, preach, saying, The kingdom of heaven is at hand. Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils: freely ye have received, freely give."

Matthew 10:7-8 KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/mat.10.7-8.KJV>

This is what Jesus meant by the main message He preached, “The kingdom of heaven is at hand” (e.g., Matthew 4:17). It means you can expect God to bring freedom and life through you right now on “earth as it is in heaven” (Matthew 6:10), for “... the kingdom of God is within you.”

Luke 17:21b KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/luk.17.21.KJV>

Quickened

If you enter into covenant with God through Christ, God pours into you fullness of life. It's why Jesus Christ came:

“The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I came that they may have life and have it abundantly. I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.”

John 10:10-11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.10.10-11.ESV>

Jesus Christ destroys the work of the devil (or “the thief”): sin and death. Jesus destroys it by quickening us with His life by way of the Spirit that lives in us:

“And you, who were dead in your trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh, God made alive together with him, having forgiven us all our trespasses,”

Colossians 2:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.2.13.ESV>

By way of that same Spirit, we, as “the light of the world” (Matthew 5:14), shine light into the kingdom of darkness, exposing it. That Spirit love incarnated to us and to our world, despite those who may be filled with hate around us. That love acts to bring freedom, life, and good to those around us. His life living in us, we are commanded, “Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good.”

Romans 12:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.12.21.ESV>

Believe and confess that God's life is in you, and He quickens you, even now. We need to embrace the life that is in us, nurture it, and let it out. That life resident in your spirit needs to make its way into all of you:

“If the Spirit of him who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you, he who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through his Spirit who dwells in you.”

Romans 8:11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.8.11.ESV>

Let that life out. You need to intentionally release it to others, as Jesus said you would: “Whoever believes in me, as the Scripture has said, ‘Out of his heart will flow rivers of living water.’” Now this he said about the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were to receive, for as yet the Spirit had not been given, because Jesus was not yet glorified.”

John 7:38-39 ESV

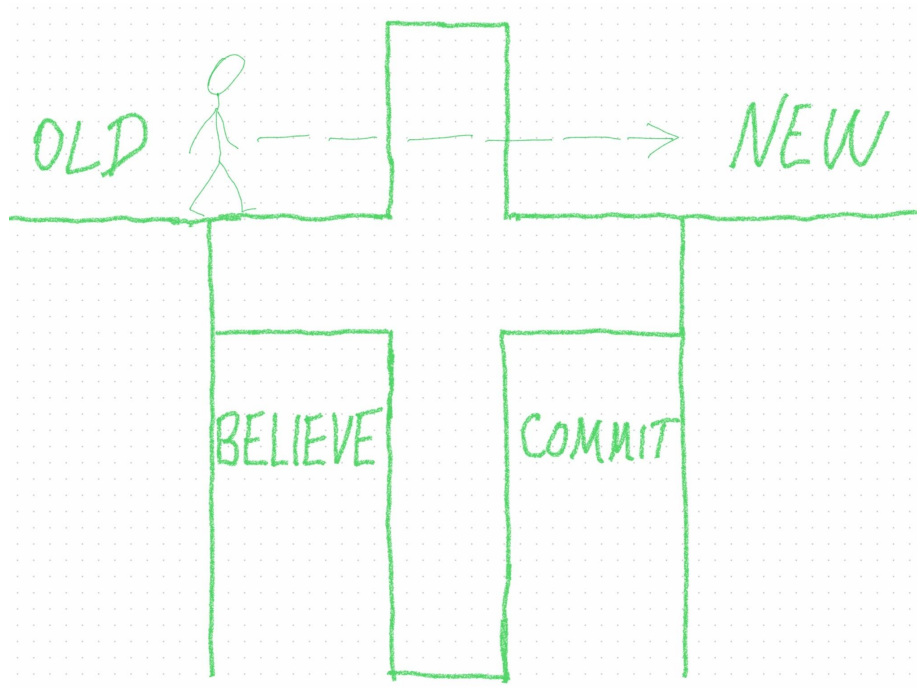
<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.7.38-39.ESV>

The Holy Spirit has been given to you, if you are now in Christ. Do not neglect the Spirit of life that is in you and waiting to flow into to your body, into your mind, and out from you to those you encounter who are in need of God’s grace and mercy. Believe and confess that you have fullness of life in you, the very life of the living God.

Christ died to give you fullness of life.

Commit

Old:	Doubt	Sin	Separation	Unrighteousness	Slavery	Death
New:	Trust	Sinless	Directly connected	Righteousness	Freedom	Life
Believe:	God is good	Jesus Christ	Holy Spirit	Full identification	Set free	Quickened
Commit:	Know God	Repentance	Fellowship	Lordship of Christ	Love	Baptism



Below are some notes for you to remember.

Commit (covenant with God, like a marriage)

Know God and know His word; become a disciple of Christ; hunger for God

Repentance: think in a new way; hate evil, old life; put to death your old self; turn away from sin and self, toward God; stay clean; commit to the renewal of your mind; commit to be conformed to Christ's nature and character

Be connected in **fellowship** to God and His functioning body, His church; be equipped

Lordship of Christ: Cede control of your life to Jesus Christ, your interests directed by Him; be led by the Spirit who lives in you; live for Him; do His will (= do His word)

Love: Love God = obey His word, the Bible; God's love acts, so love others as God loves you (in action, not feeling); accept the responsibility of a child of God; bear fruit, do good

Baptism: Be baptized as an act of obedience, and openly profess your faith in Jesus

Salvation discussion

If you want to be made new through salvation, you should commit yourself fully to God in covenant for life, not unlike the way men and women commit themselves to each other for life in Christian marriage by making sacred vows to each other. Six vows you should fully intend to keep are given next.

Commit to **know God** in truth through coming to know His word, the Bible. Commit to Him that you will hunger and thirst to know Him more. Commit that you will put the commands in His word into practice as you learn them; this is what disciples do.

Commit yourself to a lifetime of **repentance**. To repent means to think in a new way. The new way of thinking is to hate evil and to hate your old life enough to voluntarily put it to death by the continued action of your will. Having been made clean by God, you should also know that you have been empowered to stay clean.

In **repentance**, commit to turn away from your natural orientation toward sin and toward yourself, orienting yourself daily instead toward God. Commit yourself to the renewing of your mind to the word of God. With any particular word of His, your mind is not renewed to that word from God until you are consistently doing what it says. Commit yourself to be conformed to Christ's own character and nature by your cooperation with the power of the Holy Spirit, who lives in you.

Commit yourself to daily **fellowship** with God in prayer. Commit also to regular connection with Christ's functioning body through regular fellowship with a local church of disciples. Commit to connect with other disciples in this body until you experience a sense of belonging in the family of God with one or more of them. Commit to be disciplined and equipped by at least one in this body to better know and to better put into practice God's word. By putting God's word in practice together, you work together with God to meet the needs of the world.

Commit to the **lordship** of Jesus Christ in your life. Commit to abandon your will, interests, and purpose to be replaced by His. You now live for Him. Commit to be led by His indwelling Spirit. To be led by His Spirit, do the word of God.

Commit to **love** God on His terms. God's love acts. To love God is to obey His word. Commit to **love** others as God has loved you: in action, not in feeling. Commit to accept

the responsibility of being a child of God: to serve all and to do good to all, motivated out of **love**.

Commit to **baptism** as an act of obedience. Historically, baptism was an act of publicly professing faith in and commitment to following Jesus Christ, which was often expected to bring persecution. Commit to openly professing your faith in Jesus Christ, no matter the cost.

Discussion time: About two minutes

Discipleship discussion

Know God

Commit yourself to know God. Knowing God is not about getting something from Him. It's about knowing Truth (John 14:6). It's about knowing the glory of His character and nature, recognizing Him in His word. It's about understanding His righteousness and holiness. It's about coming to know His mind. It's about learning what pleases Him so you can do that. It's about learning His will to love in action and to do good.

It's about knowing that God Himself is the best thing that could ever happen to you. You must approach God first as one poor in spirit, having taken a step down; as one mourning the unrighteousness of your old life, ready to be molded; as one who is meek, willing to do what God would have you do. It's then about hungering and thirsting after Him and His righteousness, as Jesus taught in His Sermon on the Mount (Matthew 5:1-6). In order to take on God's character for yourself, you must know Him in truth.

God is best reflected in the person of Jesus Christ, so you must become a disciple of Christ to know God. Jesus Himself modeled the intimacy of a relationship with God as Father, calling Him, "Abba, Father" (Mark 14:36). Commit to develop intimacy with the God who made you, who knows you, who loves you, who gave so much for you.

Repentance

The other part of Jesus' main message that He preached was repentance:

"From that time Jesus began to preach, saying, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.""

Matthew 4:17 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.4.17.ESV>

To repent is to change your mind. *Completely*. It's a change of orientation, turning from your own purpose to His purpose (Luke 22:42).

It's coming to hate what is evil (Romans 12:9) in God's eyes enough to get rid of it. It's hating and being willing to die to your old life (John 12:25), in identification with the crucifixion of Christ (Galatians 2:20), followed by doing what is necessary to die. People who are dead (to themselves) respond differently to a pat on the back than those who are alive (Galatians 1:10). They also respond differently to being stabbed in the back (Luke 6:27-28). Commit to die to yourself.

Repentance is also coming to love what is good in God's eyes enough to consistently step out and do it.

In repenting, we obey God's words to us:

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect."

Romans 12:2 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.12.2.ESV>

Repentance is "to put off your old self, which belongs to your former manner of life and is corrupt through deceitful desires, and to be renewed in the spirit of your minds, and to put on the new self, created after the likeness of God in true righteousness and holiness."

Ephesians 4:22-24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.4.22-24.ESV>

Repentance affects how we think, what we say, and what we do:

"Do not lie to one another, seeing that you have put off the old self with its practices and have put on the new self, which is being renewed in knowledge after the image of its creator. Here there is not Greek and Jew, circumcised and uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, free; but Christ is all, and in all. Put on then, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, compassionate hearts, kindness, humility, meekness, and patience, bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive. And above all these put on love, which binds everything together in perfect harmony. And let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, to which indeed you were called in one body. And be thankful. Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly, teaching and admonishing one another in all wisdom, singing psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, with thankfulness in your hearts to God."

Colossians 3:9-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/col.3.9-16.ESV>

In repentance, we put off the old self in cooperation with and empowered by the Holy Spirit that lives in us, as dross is removed to purify gold (1 Peter 1:7). Day by day and choice by choice, we choose to put off the old self.

In repentance, we put on the new self, created after the likeness of God. It's a continued action of our will that clothes us what we've already been given in Christ.

Commit to put off the old and put on the new.

Repentance is the right condition of our lives that allows the seed of the word of God to grow up to maturity in us and produce the fruit that brings glory to God. The fruit begins with right character, the fruit of the Spirit of God in us.

Good character leads to right speaking and right action (Matthew 7:17-27). With any particular word of His, your mind is not renewed to that word from God until you are consistently doing what it says. Christ said, "My mother and my brothers are those who hear the word of God and do it."

Luke 8:21b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.8.21.ESV>

Repentance is the process by which we are transformed into sons and daughters of God who more accurately reflect God's image and more completely do God's will. His will is His word.

When two or more disciples have their minds renewed to the word of God, there is unity among them (Ephesians 4:1-6). Their mind has been conformed to the mind of the Spirit of God, or the same mind that was in Jesus Christ (Philippians 2:1-8).

Repentance is a change of mind by which one voluntarily yokes themselves to Christ and to any of those following Christ in practice. Christ's path is a narrow path, and only repentance can put you on that path (Matthew 7:13-14). If you yoke yourself to anyone else, you separate yourself from His path (2 Corinthians 6:14).

Repentance is the only path by which you may "walk in the same way in which he walked."

1 John 2:6b ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.2.6.ESV>

Jesus' command for you is, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand." Commit yourself to repentance, God's way.

Fellowship

Commit yourself to daily fellowship with God in prayer. Prayer is not mainly about asking for what we want. It's not about us. Prayer is the voluntary alignment of our thoughts and our will with those of the Spirit of God that abides within us. In prayer, we align ourselves with God's attitude, perception, emotions, goals, objectives, priorities, plans, agenda and dreams. This alignment puts us in position to receive all that we need to receive from God, as branches connected to the Vine (John 15:1-8). The misunderstanding of prayer (and of repentance) results in failure both to grow up from infancy in Christ (1 Corinthians 3:1, 13:11, Galatians 4:3, Ephesians 4:14, Hebrews 5:13) and to receive what we ask for:

"You ask and do not receive, because you ask wrongly, to spend it on your passions."

James 4:3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.4.3.ESV>

A relationship with God is not something for us to use to get things for ourselves, if Christ does not yet have rule over our lives. Unless we are committed to connection with Jesus Christ on His terms, we do not abide in Him. Jesus' connection to us is via the Holy Spirit He gives to His disciples. The Holy Spirit abides in His disciples, dwelling there continually.

As a disciple of Jesus, you are as a house with several rooms, and the Holy Spirit is only satisfied to live in you if God can make Himself completely at home in you: go anywhere in your house, do anything in your house, *nothing held back*. And the Spirit is holy, so you must be as well, empowered by God, if you want God to abide there.

Commit yourself to fellowship with God on His terms, so you may be connected to the Vine (John 15:1), the channel of God through which everything good from Him flows. Then abide there.

Commit yourself also to regular connection with Christ's functioning body through regular fellowship with a local church of disciples. You are a member of Christ's body (Romans 12:4-5). Members of His body do not survive when separated from it. Instead, they need the body to belong to, to grow and to be sustained.

Commit to connect with other disciples for belonging, for growth, and for function. Find belonging with those Christ called His family, those who hear the word of God and do it

(Luke 8:21). If those you have connected with do not put the word of God into practice in their daily lives, go elsewhere to find some disciples.

You also need connection to this body in order to grow. Commit to be discipled and equipped by at least one doer of His word in order to better know God's word and put it into practice. You will not grow if you do not regularly put God's word into practice (Proverbs 11:25), so learning must always be followed by doing. By putting God's word in practice together, you meet the needs of the world (Matthew 6:10, 25:40; James 1:27; 1 John 3:17-18), functioning as co-workers together with God (Mark 16:1, 1 Corinthians 3:9, 2 Corinthians 6:1). Collectively, Christ's disciples are His Christ's body in this world, functioning together to continue Christ's ministry (1 Corinthians 12:4-11, Romans 12:6-8), just as ambassadors represent and carry out the work of some head (2 Corinthians 5:17-20).

For the sake of fellowship, commit yourself to be of one mind with Christ. The body needs to respond to the one mind that directs the body. In the body of Christ, this is the mind of the Spirit of God, which we have:

““For who has understood the mind of the Lord so as to instruct him?” But we have the mind of Christ.”

1 Corinthians 2:16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.2.16.ESV>

To try to keep our own thoughts, will, and purpose outside of Christ makes us double-minded (James 1:7-8). Double-minded members hinder the unity and the function of Christ's body, so commit yourself to repentance.

Commit yourself to pursue the unity of the fellowship of disciples. We are not to divide what God has joined together (Matthew 19:6). Instead, we are to be peacemakers (Matthew 5:9): those who speak peace (Luke 10:5, 1 Thessalonians 5:11-14). We are to be those who take the initiative and who do everything in their power to restore peace (Romans 12:18, 14:19) following division.

Lordship of Christ

It's not about you. It's not about what you want. You must commit to the lordship of Christ, or you are not His disciple. This means you belong to Jesus Christ, purchased with His blood (Acts 20:28). In calling Him Lord, you cede control of your life to Jesus Christ, and your interests become directed by His. As a citizen with right standing in His kingdom, He has rule over your life.

Christ would not consider anyone His disciple unless they left their life behind without hesitation to follow Him (Luke 9:57-62). To those who did follow, He said, ““Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord,’ and not do what I tell you? Everyone who comes to me and hears my words and does them, I will show you what he is like: he is like a man building a house, who dug deep and laid the foundation on the rock. And when a flood arose, the stream broke against that house and could not shake it, because it had been well built. But the one who hears and does not do them is like a man who built a house on the ground without a foundation. When the stream broke against it, immediately it fell, and the ruin of that house was great.””

Luke 6:46-49 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.6.46-49.ESV>

Disciples are expected to do what Jesus said to do, or, put another way, do God’s word. Having spent a lot of time with Jesus, Jesus’ brother James instructed new disciples of Christ, “... be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves.”

James 1:22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.1.22.ESV>

Moreover, in thinking on Christ as our Lord, we should know that Christ is no longer the same as He was on earth after His glorification:

“Therefore God has highly exalted him and bestowed on him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth, and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.”

Philippians 2:9-11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.2.9-11.ESV>

Christ is now highly exalted as Lord over all. He came to proclaim the gospel of the kingdom and to demonstrate it (Matthew 4:23, 9:35, 24:14). He has the right and authority to rule over all things.

Although John the Apostle knew Jesus well in life, when John saw Him glorified, he “fell at his feet as though dead”:

“When I saw him, I fell at his feet as though dead. But he laid his right hand on me, saying, “Fear not, I am the first and the last, and the living one. I died, and behold I am alive forevermore, and I have the keys of Death and Hades.”

Revelation 1:17-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.1.17-18.ESV>

Christ is Lord over all, but not all voluntarily submit their will to Him now.

If Christ is Lord over you, that means none other can be – not you, not any other man or woman, no job. Commit to seeking the approval of God in the daily decisions you make. Consider what the Apostle Paul said, “For am I now seeking the approval of man, or of God? Or am I trying to please man? If I were still trying to please man, I would not be a servant of Christ.”

Galatians 1:10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.1.10.ESV>

Further, you should not allow the fear of man to hold you back from doing what is right in God’s eyes, including proclaiming the gospel and giving testimony about Him.

“There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear...”

1 John 4:18a ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.4.18.ESV>

Commit to the lordship of Christ over all of your life. In order to exalt Christ as Lord, you must also commit to die to yourself (Luke 9:23-26).

Love

Commit to love God on His terms.

First, you are love God with your everything, nothing held back:

“And you shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.”

Mark 12:30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.12.30.ESV>

This is the most important commandment, according to Jesus. One that loves God the Father like this is one in which the Holy Spirit will abide; it’s one connected to Jesus Christ, the Vine. If we love God, we will obey His word out of love. To love God is to obey His word.

Second, you “...shall love your neighbor as yourself”

Mark 12:31a ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.12.31.ESV>

and ““...whatever you wish that others would do to you, do also to them, for this is the Law and the Prophets.”

Matthew 7:12 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.7.12.ESV>

Further, Jesus said to His disciples:

“A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another: just as I have loved you, you also are to love one another. By this all people will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another.”

John 13:34-35 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.13.34-35.ESV>

As Christ's disciple then, commit to love in action. God's love acts. It's not a feeling. Commit to love others as God has loved you: in action, not in feeling. Consider what you would have done for you, if you were in their situation.

Commit to accept the responsibility of being a child of God: to serve all and to do good to all out of love, not picking or choosing. Here is how we are to use the freedom we have been given:

“For you were called to freedom, brothers. Only do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh, but through love serve one another. For the whole law is fulfilled in one word: “You shall love your neighbor as yourself.”

Galatians 5:13-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gal.5.13-14.ESV>

Further, we are not able to love God while hating any of His image bearers:

“If anyone says, “I love God,” and hates his brother, he is a liar; for he who does not love his brother whom he has seen cannot love God whom he has not seen. And this commandment we have from him: whoever loves God must also love his brother.”

1 John 4:20-21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.4.20-21.ESV>

We are expected to show mercy, forgiveness, and the grace of God to all, our enemies included, just as God has done with us. The grace of God is to lead us to holy living and to good works:

“For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation for all people, training us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live self-controlled, upright, and godly lives in the present age, waiting for our blessed hope, the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ, who gave himself for us to redeem us from all lawlessness and to purify for himself a people for his own possession who are zealous for good works.”

Titus 2:11-14 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/tit.2.11-14.ESV>

Commit to the changing work of God in your heart that transforms you into one that loves God and loves people according to God's expectations for love. With your commitment, you can expect the Spirit of God to pour His own love into your heart (Romans 5:5).

In love, you have the opportunity to build a house upon the foundation of Jesus Christ. You have the opportunity to help build up God's family, His church. There is a reward for such work (1 Corinthians 3:6-15). The greatest thing that God will give you is His own love (1 Corinthians 13:13). The world desperately needs to know the love of God.

Baptism

In obedience to God's word, commit to be baptized at the earliest possible occasion. Jesus commanded His disciples to baptize new disciples:

"Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you. And behold, I am with you always, to the end of the age."

Matthew 28:19-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.28.19-20.ESV>

Historically, baptism had been a public, outward sign of what God had done in a new disciple of Jesus Christ. Through a new disciple's belief, commitment, and confession, they are: fully identified with Jesus in His crucifixion, resurrection, and glorification; made clean and righteous, just as Jesus is; completely set free from sin and death; directly connected with the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit; made alive (quickened) in Christ. The old being is miraculously recreated into a new being that never before existed.

Now, even if your baptism is done in private, commit to the public profession of your new faith in Christ. After all, everything is made new, and there is no reason to hide the work of God in you. You are to be light:

"You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden. Nor do people light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on a stand, and it gives light to all in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven."

Matthew 5:14-16 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.5.14-16.ESV>

Commit to being light and life and love to others, for Christ lives in you now. God has remade you good in order to be His eyes, ears, hands and feet to do good in this world. You are God's glory. Know also that when you fulfill your purpose, it brings Him glory.

Confess and commit

Here is a summary of those things to which a new disciple of Christ should confess and commit.

Confess

Believe and confess that **God is good**. God wants good for you. He loves you. He is merciful to you.

Believe and confess that **Jesus Christ** is God's only provision for your sin.

Believe and confess that Jesus Christ died for your sins in accordance with the Scriptures, that He was buried, that He was raised on the third day in accordance with the Scriptures, and that He appeared to [Peter], then to the twelve; then He appeared to more than five hundred brothers at one time. (from 1 Corinthians 15:3b-6a)

Believe and confess that you receive God's gift of salvation right now.

Believe and confess that you now have **full identification** with Jesus Christ in all things, including in His crucifixion and resurrection.

Believe and confess that you are now a child of God with the associated inheritance and responsibility that it brings.

Believe and confess that you are seated with Jesus Christ in heavenly places right now.

Believe and confess that right now you receive the **Holy Spirit** along with power.

Believe and confess that Christ lives in you right now.

Believe and confess that you are now directly connected to God as Jesus is.

Believe and confess that you have been **set free** by the finished work of Jesus Christ from sin and death, their effects, and any oppression; they have no right to you in Jesus' name.

Believe and confess that "There is therefore now no condemnation for me because I am in Christ Jesus. The law of the Spirit of life has set me free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death." (from Romans 8:1-2)

Believe and confess that you have been made clean.

Believe and confess that God's way is the only one that truly leads to freedom for you and for others.

Believe and confess that you are now **quicken**ed (made alive) by God's life.

Believe and confess that God's life is in you, and He quickens you, even now.

Believe and confess that you have fullness of life in you, the very life of the living God.

Believe and confess that you no longer live, but it is now Christ who lives in you.

Believe and confess that you have been saved; it is a finished work.

Commit

Commit yourself fully to God in covenant for life, holding nothing back.

Commit to **know God** in truth through coming to know His word, the Bible.

Commit to Him that you will hunger and thirst to know Him more.

Commit that you will put the commands in His word into practice as you learn them.

Commit to develop intimacy with the God who made you, who knows you, who loves you, who gave so much for you.

Commit yourself to a lifetime of **repentance**.

Commit to turn away from your natural orientation toward sin and toward yourself, orienting yourself daily instead toward God.

Commit yourself to hate evil (itself, not evil people).

Commit to hate your old life enough to voluntarily put it to death by the continued action of your will.

Commit yourself to the renewing of your mind to the word of God.

Commit to put off the old and to put on the new.

Commit to stay clean.

Commit yourself to be conformed to Christ's own character and nature by your cooperation with the power of the Holy Spirit, who lives in you.

Commit yourself to be of one mind with Christ.

Commit yourself to daily **fellowship** with God in prayer.

Commit yourself to fellowship with God on His terms, so you may be connected to the Vine (John 15:5).

Commit to connect with other disciples for belonging, for growth, and for function.

Commit to regular connection with Christ's functioning body through regular fellowship with a local church of disciples.

Commit to connect with other disciples in this body until you experience a sense of belonging in the family of God with one or more of them.

Commit to be discipled and equipped by at least one in this body to better know and to better put into practice God's word.

Commit yourself to pursue the unity of the fellowship of disciples.

Commit to the **lordship of Christ** over all of your life.

Commit to abandon your will, interests, and purpose to be replaced by His.

Commit to be led by His indwelling Spirit, doing the word of God.

Commit to seeking the approval of God in the daily decisions you make.

Commit to **love** God on His terms.

Commit to the changing work of God in your heart that transforms you into one that loves God and loves people according to God's expectations for love.

Commit to love others as God has loved you: in action, not in feeling.

Commit to accept the responsibility of being a child of God: to serve *all* and to do good to *all* out of love, not picking or choosing.

Commit to **baptism** as an act of obedience at the earliest possible occasion.

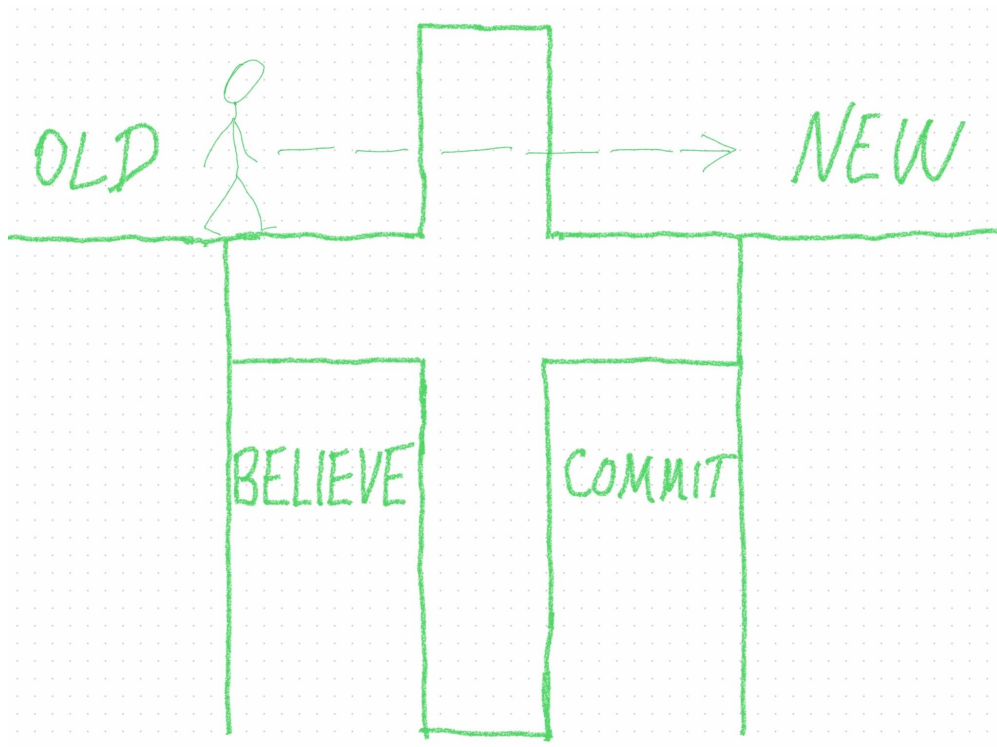
Commit to openly and publicly professing your faith in Jesus Christ, no matter the cost.

Commit to being light and life and love to others, for Christ lives in you now

Appendix: Words prompts translations

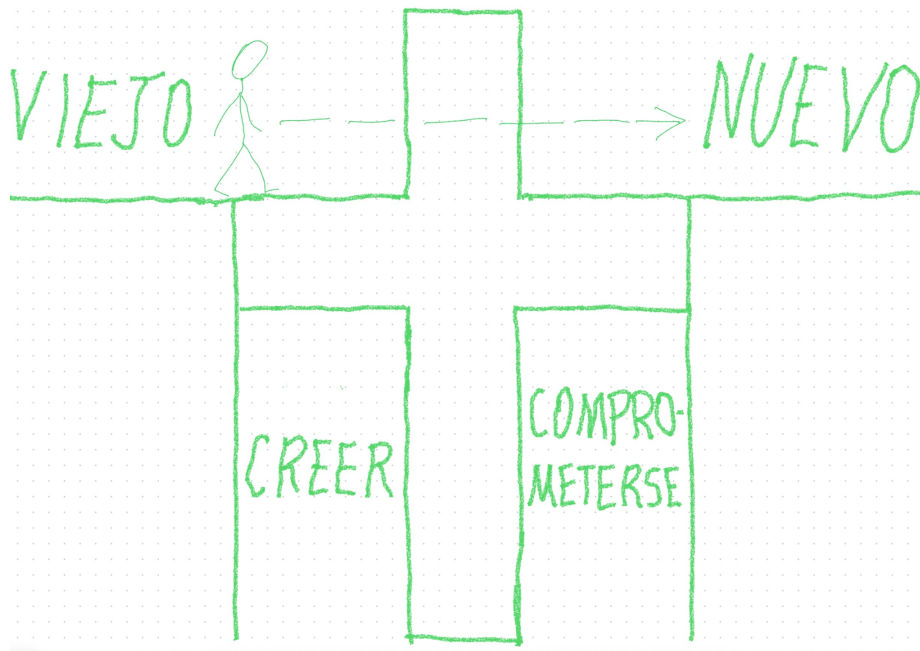
English

Old:	Doubt	Sin	Separation	Unrighteousness	Slavery	Death
New:	Trust	Sinless	Directly connected	Righteousness	Freedom	Life
Believe:	God is good	Jesus Christ	Holy Spirit	Full identification	Set free	Quickened
Commit:	Know God	Repentance	Fellowship	Lordship of Christ	Love	Baptism



Espanol

Viejo:	Duda	Pecado	Separación	Injusticia	Esclavitud	Muerte
Nuevo:	Confianza	Puro	Directamente conectado	Justica	Libertad	Vida
Creer:	Dios es bueno	Jesucristo	Espíritu Santo	Identificación completa	Liberar	Acelerado
Comprometerse:	Conocer a dios	Arrepentimiento	Compañerismo	Señorío de Cristo	Amar	Bautismo



Português

Velho:	Dúvida	Pecado	Separação	Injustiça	Escravidão	Morte
Novo:	Confiar	Sem pecado	Diretamente conectado	Justiça	Liberdade	Vida
Acreditar:	Dues é bom	Jesus Cristo	Espírito Santo	Identificação completa	Libertar	Acelerado
Comprometer-se:	Conheça Deus	Arrependimento	Irmandade	Senhorio de Cristo	Amor	Batismo

